

SETUP GUIDE · V1.0

Video Analysis with Claude Code & Gemini

From zero to dashboard in 30 minutes

Drop a folder of ad videos · Tell Claude to analyze them · Get an interactive HTML
dashboard with structured creative breakdowns

What you'll need

01 A computer

Windows, macOS, or Linux. All work.

02 Claude Code installed

Download at anthropic.com/claude-code

03 A Google account

For the free Gemini API key. No credit card needed.

04 ~30 minutes for setup

One time. After this — drop videos, get dashboard. ~5 minutes per batch.

No coding required

You don't need to know Python, JavaScript, or any programming. The scripts are pre-built. You're following a recipe — and Claude Code does the technical parts.

9 steps

00	Get the starter kit	5 MIN
01	Pick a folder	2 MIN
02	Copy the starter files	3 MIN
03	Open in Claude Code	1 MIN
04	Install Python and ffmpeg	15–25 MIN
05	Get a free Gemini API key	3 MIN
06	Save the API key in .env	5 MIN
07	First video analysis	5–10 MIN
08	Daily workflow	ONGOING



Get the starter kit

~5 MINUTES

You need the project files (this guide, the scripts, the CLAUDE.md, etc.) before anything else. Pick whichever option fits how you received them.

Option A – From GitHub as ZIP **RECOMMENDED**

1. Open `github.com/adrealms/video-analysis-starter`
2. Click the green **Code** button → **Download ZIP**
3. Extract the ZIP (right-click → Extract All on Windows, double-click on macOS)
4. Remember where you extracted it — you'll use that path in Step 2

Option B – Clone with git

If you already use git:

```
git clone https://github.com/adrealms/video-analysis-starter.git
```

Option C – Received from someone

If a colleague sent you the kit directly: save it somewhere easy to find (e.g. Desktop), extract if it's a ZIP, remember the path.

✓ CHECKPOINT

You have a folder somewhere on your computer containing `README.md`, `CLAUDE.md`, `.env.example`, `.gitignore`, a `scripts/` folder with 5 Python files, and an empty `videos/` folder.

01 Pick a folder

~2 MINUTES

This folder will hold the scripts, configuration, and all your video projects. Pick somewhere easy to find again.

Windows

Recommended: `C:\Users\<your-name>\video-analysis\`

Open File Explorer → navigate to `C:\Users\<your-name>\` → right-click in empty space → New → Folder → name it `video-analysis`.

macOS

Recommended: `~/video-analysis/`

Open Finder → press `⌘ Shift H` → File menu → New Folder → name it `video-analysis`.

Linux

Recommended: `~/video-analysis/`

In file manager: navigate to home directory, create new folder. Or in terminal: `mkdir ~/video-analysis`

✓ CHECKPOINT

An empty folder named **video-analysis** exists at the location of your choice. You know exactly where it is so you can navigate to it later.

02 Copy the starter files

~3 MINUTES

Copy ALL of the following from the starter kit (downloaded in Step 0) into your new `video-analysis/` folder.

```
video-analysis/  
├─ README.md  
├─ CLAUDE.md  
├─ .env.example  
├─ .gitignore  
├─ scripts/ (5 Python files)  
└─ videos/ (empty)
```

Windows tip: if `.env.example` and `.gitignore` are hidden, enable **View → Hidden items** in File Explorer.

✓ CHECKPOINT

Your **video-analysis/** folder contains all 4 root files, the `scripts/` folder with 5 .py files, and the empty `videos/` folder. The original starter kit you downloaded can be deleted.

03

Open in Claude Code

~1 MINUTE

Claude Code is the AI assistant that runs the pipeline. It needs to be "connected" to your project folder.

1. Launch **Claude Code** on your computer.
2. Open the **video-analysis/** folder you created in Step 1.
3. Claude Code will automatically read the `CLAUDE.md` file in that folder.

To verify it loaded the project context:

TYPE IN CLAUDE CODE

What is this project?

Claude should respond explaining the 3-stage video analysis pipeline. If it says "I don't know" — verify `CLAUDE.md` exists in the root of your folder and try reopening.

✓ CHECKPOINT

Claude Code is open with **video-analysis/** as the working folder. Claude correctly describes the 3-stage video analysis pipeline when asked.

04

Install Python and ffmpeg

~15–25 MINUTES

Only "technical" step. Claude Code does the work — you just send one request and wait.

Windows

Claude will install **WSL** (mini-Linux inside Windows), then Python and packages inside it.

TYPE IN CLAUDE CODE

```
Set up WSL with Ubuntu, install Python 3.12, ffmpeg, and the Python packages I need for this project (google-genai, weasyprint, pypdf, pymupdf, pillow).
```

⚠ WSL install may need admin rights and a Windows restart. Claude will tell you when.

macOS

TYPE IN CLAUDE CODE

```
Install Homebrew if it's not already installed, then install ffmpeg and Python 3.12. Then install the Python packages: google-genai, weasyprint, pypdf, pymupdf, pillow.
```

Linux

TYPE IN CLAUDE CODE

```
Install ffmpeg, Python 3.12, and the Python packages google-genai, weasyprint, pypdf, pymupdf, pillow.
```

Verify the install:

TYPE IN CLAUDE CODE

```
Run the API health check script to verify Python and the Gemini package are installed correctly.
```

Expected output: "No API key in .env" — that's normal. You haven't added the key yet (Step 5). It confirms Python is working.

✓ CHECKPOINT

Python, ffmpeg and required packages installed. The health-check script runs and shows the expected 'No API key in .env' message (not a 'module not found' error).

05

Get a free Gemini API key

~3 MINUTES

You need this for Stage 1 transcription. Free tier covers ~50 videos/day — enough for testing and small agency batches.

1. Open `aistudio.google.com/app/apikey`
2. Sign in with any Google account
3. Click "**Create API key**" (top right or center)
4. Choose "**Create API key in new project**"
5. A long string starting with `AIza...` appears — **copy it**
6. Keep the AI Studio tab open in case you need it again

Privacy: on free tier, Google may use your video uploads for model improvement. For client-confidential work, enable paid billing (see end of guide). For your own brand testing, free tier is fine.

✓ CHECKPOINT

You have a long string starting with `AIza...` copied to your clipboard. The AI Studio tab is still open in case you need to copy it again.

06 Save the API key

~5 MIN · PART 1 OF 2

The key lives in a file called `.env` inside your project folder. Claude needs it for Gemini API calls — but Claude itself should never see the actual key. **You'll paste it manually.**

Two ways to create the file. **Method A is recommended.**

Method A — Ask Claude Code **RECOMMENDED**

Works the same on all OS, no extension-related Windows headaches.

TYPE IN CLAUDE CODE

Create a `.env` file in this project from `.env.example`. Don't put a real key in it — leave the placeholder. I'll paste the key myself.

Method B — Through File Explorer

Open your **video-analysis/** folder (the one from Step 1 with the files from Step 2). Then:

Windows:

1. View tab → check **"File name extensions"** ← critical
2. Right-click `.env.example` → Copy, then Paste
3. Rename the copy to exactly `.env` → click **Yes** to "no extension" warning

macOS:

1. Right-click `.env.example` → Duplicate
2. Rename copy to `.env` → click **Use "."**

06 Save the API key

~5 MIN · PART 2 OF 2

Paste your key

Once `.env` exists, open it in a plain text editor:

Windows: right-click `.env` → Open with → Notepad

macOS: right-click → Open with → TextEdit

Linux: right-click → Open with text editor

You'll see:

```
GEMINI_API_KEY=PASTE_YOUR_KEY_HERE
```

Replace `PASTE_YOUR_KEY_HERE` with your AIza ... key:

```
GEMINI_API_KEY=AIzaSyABC ... long_string_here ... XYZ123
```

Critical: no quotes around the key, no spaces around the = sign. Pure KEY=VALUE format. Save the file (Ctrl+S or ⌘S) and close.

Verify the file is really called `.env`

On Windows, Notepad sometimes saves with a hidden `.txt` extension. Ask Claude Code:

TYPE IN CLAUDE CODE

Check whether I have a file named exactly `".env"` (not `".env.txt"` or `".env.example"`) in this project folder.

If it reports `.env.txt` instead — fix it:

TYPE IN CLAUDE CODE

Rename `.env.txt` to `.env` in this project folder.

Test the key

TYPE IN CLAUDE CODE

Verify my Gemini API key works by running the test API script.

✓ CHECKPOINT

Running the test script shows 'Connecting to Gemini API... ✓ 50 models available' plus a list of `gemini-2.x-flash`, `gemini-2.5-pro`, etc. **Setup complete.**

07 First video analysis

~5–10 MINUTES

Drop videos into a project folder

Inside `video-analysis/videos/`, create a subfolder for your project — name it whatever makes sense (e.g. `my-first-test`, `competitor-research`, `client-fitness`). Drop 1–10 video files inside.

```
videos/  
└─ my-first-test/  
   ├── creative_01.mp4  
   ├── creative_02.mp4  
   └─ creative_03.mov
```

Tip: start with 2–3 short videos (under 30 sec) for the first run.

Tell Claude to analyze them

TYPE IN CLAUDE CODE

Analyze videos in `my-first-test`

Replace `my-first-test` with your folder name. Claude runs all 3 stages: Gemini transcription → strategic table → HTML dashboard.

When done, Claude tells you the path to your dashboard. **Double-click that file** to open it in your browser.

✓ CHECKPOINT

Dashboard opens in your browser. One card per video with thumbnail and concept label. Clicking a card opens the per-video page where video plays in the left column and clicking timestamps in tables jumps the video to that moment.

08 Daily workflow

ONGOING

After setup is done, the daily loop is just **3 actions**:

1 Create a project folder
e.g. `videos/promo-june/`

2 Drop videos in
Any `.mp4`, `.mov`, `.webm`, `.m4v`, or `.mkv`

3 Ask Claude
`analyze videos in promo-june`

Other useful requests

Cross-video insights: Summarize the videos in `promo-june`

Compare batches: Compare hook patterns between `promo-may` and `promo-june`

Generate new scripts: Write a new ad in the style of `competitor-research`, for `[my product]`

Refresh one video: Refresh analysis for `creative_03`

If something goes wrong

"I don't know what this project is"

Claude Code didn't load CLAUDE.md. Verify the file is named exactly CLAUDE.md (case-sensitive on Linux/macOS), is in the root of your folder, and reopen the folder in Claude Code.

"GEMINI_API_KEY not found"

Check that .env exists in the root (not .env.example, not .env.txt). Line format must be exactly GEMINI_API_KEY=AIZA... — no quotes, no spaces around =.

"429 RESOURCE_EXHAUSTED" during analysis

Free tier rate limit. Script auto-retries up to 5 times. If still failing, wait 1 minute and re-run (already-processed videos are skipped). Or enable paid Gemini tier.

.mov files don't play in the dashboard

Script auto-converts .mov → .mp4. If a .mov still doesn't play, ask Claude: Re-render dashboard for <folder> and force-convert all .mov files.

Thumbnails not showing in dashboard

Browser might block local images. Try reloading. Or ask Claude to open the dashboard via a local server: Start a local server for the dashboard folder.

OPTIONAL

Going to **paid** Gemini

Free tier is enough for testing and ~50 videos/day. For agency work with client data, paid offers real upgrades:

Data privacy

Your videos are **not used for training**. Critical for client confidentiality.

Higher rate limits

15 RPM → **2,000 RPM**. Batch 100 videos in minutes instead of hours.

Gemini 2.5 Pro access

Free tier blocks Pro. Paid unlocks deeper analysis (10–20× more expensive than Flash, still cents per video).

Pricing example

100 videos/month on Flash ≈ **\$3–5 total**. On Pro ≈ \$10–15.

How to enable

1. Go to `console.cloud.google.com/billing`
2. Link a billing account to your AI Studio project
3. Set a budget cap (**\$20–50/month** is plenty) under Billing → Budgets & Alerts

Same API key works. No script changes needed.

YOU'RE DONE

Drop videos.
Ask Claude.
Open the dashboard.

Questions or improvements? Open an issue on GitHub or DM me on LinkedIn.

github.com/adrealms/video-analysis-starter

linkedin.com/in/leks-li

adrealms.github.io